

Physiotherapy for Chronic Pain

Move without fearing an accidental flare again.

Chronic pain changes the way you move through the world. Over time, this can affect your strength, mobility, confidence, work, sleep, and ability to do the things that matter to you.

At Pain Clinic Australia, physiotherapy is a core component of our multimodal pain care framework.

It's designed to help you better understand your body's movement, build confidence in what you can do, and develop practical strategies for managing pain during everyday activities.

You don't have to put your life on hold due to pain

[START MOVING AGAIN]

When Moving Makes You Brace

The sensitisation that progresses with chronic pain can be terrifying.

You may find yourself moving differently to avoid pain, doing less of the activities you enjoy, or worrying that a particular movement could cause a flare-up.

And when you've been living with pain for a long time, it can become difficult to know what your body can safely handle.

That doesn't mean you're weak, lazy, or doing something wrong.

Physiotherapy can help you understand your movement patterns and gradually work towards feeling more confident and capable in your body.

How Physiotherapy Helps with Pain

Physiotherapy provides evidence-based practical guidance on how to move and function when living with constant pain.

Depending on your needs, it may help you:

Build confidence in movement

When pain has made movement itself feel frightening or unpredictable, it's easy to lose confidence in what your body can do.

With appropriate guidance, physiotherapy can help you gradually rebuild trust in your body's ability to move.

Improve strength and mobility

Chronic pain, reduced activity, or changes in the way you move can affect your strength, flexibility, and physical function.

Your physiotherapist can help you identify areas that may benefit from targeted movement and exercise.

Find ways to move with less fear

You shouldn't have to choose between avoiding movement entirely and pushing through pain.

Physiotherapy can help you explore ways to approach movement that are appropriate for your individual condition, abilities, and goals.

Manage flare-ups and difficult days

Chronic pain doesn't always follow a predictable pattern.

Your physiotherapist can help you develop practical strategies for adapting your activity when symptoms change, rather than feeling like you've failed whenever you have a difficult day.

Get back to the things that matter

Pain management isn't only about how far you can move or how much exercise you can tolerate.

It's also about helping you work towards the activities, routines, relationships, and everyday experiences that make your life yours.

What Happens During Physiotherapy?

Your exercises are designed to support and enhance your current capacity, symptoms, and fitness goals.

Our physiotherapists will examine how pain is affecting your day-to-day while taking note of your overall medical history. Afterwards, an approach that takes your existing abilities and circumstances into account will be developed.

Your session may include:

- Discussing your pain, movement, and physical function
- Looking at how pain affects your everyday activities
- Identifying movements or activities you may be avoiding
- Assessing strength, mobility, balance, or other aspects of physical function where appropriate
- Developing personalised movement or exercise strategies
- Learning ways to modify activities during flare-ups
- Working towards meaningful functional goals
- Reviewing your progress and adjusting your approach over time

Notice how it was never mentioned to "push through the pain."

In physical therapy, the goal is to help you move with confidence again so you can get the most out of life.

Not about having the perfect body; but the ability to open more doors for yourself that comes with **being able to move freely**.

Care Beyond the Physical

Your body doesn't exist in isolation — and neither should your pain care.

Chronic pain can affect far more than how you move. That's why our physiotherapists work alongside a broader team, with personalised pain plans that can incorporate *psychotherapy, tailored pain formulations, and dietary guidance*.

Our experts may also work alongside your primary healthcare providers when an underlying condition is contributing to your pain.

[EXPLORE YOUR TREATMENT OPTIONS]

Frequently Asked Questions

Will physiotherapy make my chronic pain worse?

Not necessarily. Some movement or exercise can temporarily increase symptoms, particularly when your body is not accustomed to an activity.

Your physiotherapist can help you find an appropriate starting point and adjust your approach based on how your body responds.

The goal isn't to force your body through pain. It's to develop a sustainable approach to movement that works for you.

Do I have to exercise if I have chronic pain?

Not all exercise looks the same.

Your physiotherapy approach should take your current abilities, symptoms, preferences, and goals into account.

Your physiotherapist can help you explore forms of movement that are appropriate for your circumstances rather than simply giving you a generic exercise programme.

What if I'm afraid to move because of my pain?

That's understandable.

When you've experienced pain during movement, it's natural to become cautious about doing something that might make it worse.

Physiotherapy can help you understand your movement and gradually work towards rebuilding confidence in what your body can do.

Can physiotherapy cure my chronic pain?

There is no single treatment that can cure every type of chronic pain.

Physiotherapy may help you improve physical function, develop movement strategies, and manage the impact of pain on your everyday life.

Your physiotherapist can also help identify when further assessment or support from other healthcare professionals may be appropriate.

Reclaim the Freedom to Move from Pain

When every movement carries the risk of triggering pain, it's natural to become more cautious.

But your own body shouldn't become something you feel like you have to guard against.

You don't have to go from avoiding movement to doing everything at once. You can start with where you are.

We'll help you take the next step towards **moving with more confidence** and **building your range of motion** to make more room for the life you want to live.

One movement, one goal, one spoon at a time.

[GET IN TOUCH WITH US]